

Time, freshness and comparable-cutoff policy

Purpose

Prevent elapsed time, arrival order or mismatched cutoffs from becoming invented payment outcomes. Timing expectations are versioned synthetic configuration, not assumptions copied from real payment networks.

Platform Owner owns effective configuration/clock semantics. Settlement, Delivery and Reconciliation Owners own their bounded comparisons. This policy applies across stages wherever a conclusion depends on deadlines or freshness.

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Risks / sources	R09, R12, R13, R14, R15, R16, R19, R20 / E07, E08, E09, E10, E11

Synthetic notice: All systems, records, roles and amounts are fictional. Guidance is advisory and never executes an action.

Mandatory timing and comparison rules

Time provenance

Records must preserve UTC source event time, received time and snapshot collection time separately. Source sequence/version orders records only within its defined stream. Cross-source timestamps alone must not resolve final-result disagreement. Known clock uncertainty must remain explicit; missing clock data is not zero offset.

Authorization deadlines, hold expiry, refund expectations, retry budgets and batch cutoffs must reference effective configuration identity and interval. V1 sets no universal duration. If the applicable rule or event-time basis is absent, analysts must not assert overdue, expired or safe repeat. Crossing an expected time can justify requesting confirmation but must not create a terminal payment outcome.

Freshness and completeness

Source-specific freshness rules must be stated rather than silently applying one cache timeout to every source. A stale snapshot establishes historical facts only. Complete-empty results are bounded to the covered query; truncated pages, retention loss and unsupported filters must prevent completeness claims.

Comparable inputs

Reconciliation must compare the same tenant, SYN_UNIT, covered cutoff and operation membership. A changing OPEN batch cannot be compared as if it were CLOSED. Receipt and local snapshot versions must identify the same membership scope. Comparable totals without matching membership do not establish correctness.

Delayed/reordered messages must remain distinguishable from late source events. An acknowledgement establishes recipient receipt, not the freshness or correctness of its view. An exhausted retry budget does not prove payment failure.

Owners and unresolved timing

Required responsibility

Role	Responsibility
Platform Owner	Supply effective configuration, timezone/cutoff interpretation and clock uncertainty
Source Owner	Identify retained coverage, sequence semantics and snapshot freshness
Reconciliation / Settlement Owner	Verify comparable membership/cutoffs before discrepancy conclusions
Payment Operations	Record absent rules and distinguish observation from timing inference

Exceptions and changes

Missing timing rules must result in an evidence request and unresolved assertion, not an invented deadline. A change to cutoffs, clock interpretation or retention must be versioned and reviewed for affected historical comparisons. Past event timestamps must not be rewritten to make an investigation timeline consistent.

Retained evidence and review

Retain effective rule IDs, source timestamps/versions, coverage, membership and before/after comparison scopes. Owners must review these controls after timing, delivery or reconciliation contract changes. Validation after an authorized configuration correction must use compatible windows and preserve past snapshots. Rollback changes future configuration only; it does not invalidate retained facts.

E07-E11 are future source requirements, not current console capabilities. Current MCP aggregate windows cannot establish item-level deadlines or batch correctness. Incomplete/degraded report evidence retains Q6 LOW/null fields.

Related guidance and revision

Related documents: RB-107, RB-109, RB-110, PL-101.

Version 1.0.0, effective 2026-10-01. Initial independent risk-derived issue. Review cadence: annual, or before a material domain/source/control change.